THE MARINE ENVIRONMENT PROTECTION COMMITTEE, RECALLING Article 38(a) of the Convention on the International Maritime Organization concerning the functions of the Marine Environment Protection Committee conferred upon it by international conventions for the prevention and control of marine pollution from ships, RECALLING ALSO that the International Conference on Ballast Water Management for Ships held in February 2004 adopted the International Convention for the Control and Management of Ships' Ballast Water and Sediments, 2004 (the BWM Convention) together with four Conference resolutions, NOTING that regulation B -2 of the BWM Convention enables the use of electronic record books, RECOGNIZING the need to develop guidance for the use of electronic record books under the BWM Convention, - Conference resolutions, NOTING that regulation B -2 of the BWM Convention enables the use of electronic record books, RECOGNIZING the need to develop guidance for the use of electronic record books under the BWM Convention, HAVING CONSIDERED, at its eightieth session, draft Guidelines for the use of electronic record books under the BWM Convention, 1 ADOPTS the Guidelines for the use of electronic record books under the BWM Convention, the text of which is set out in the annex to this resolution; 2 INVITES Governments to apply the Guidelines as soon as possible; 3 AGREES to keep the Guidelines under review in light of experience gained. RESOLUTION MEPC.372(80) (adopted on 7 July 2023) GUIDELINES FOR THE USE OF ELECTRONIC RECORD BOOKS UNDER THE BWM CONVENTIONMEPC 80/17/Add.1 Annex 6, page 2 I:\MEPC\80\MEPC 80-17-Add.1.docx ANNEX GUIDELINES FOR THE USE OF ELECTRONIC RECORD BOOKS UNDER THE BWM CONVENTION 1 INTRODUCTION 1.1 Akey element of the International Convention for the Control and Management of Ships' Ballast Water and Sediments, 2004 (BWM Convention) regulations is the recording of ballast water operations from ships. - 1 INTRODUCTION 1.1 Akey element of the International Convention for the Control and Management of Ships' Ballast Water and Sediments, 2004 (BWM Convention) regulations is the recording of ballast water operations from ships. 1.2 The format for the recording of ballast water operations under the BWM Convention is provided in appendix II to the BWM Convention. 1.3 As companies and shipowners increasingly focus on ways to operate in an environmentally responsible manner and aim to reduce the heavy burden associated with paperwork through electronic means, the concept of operational logs in an electronic format has become apopular consideration. It is considered that this approach to recording and reporting should be encouraged as it may have many benefits for the retention of records by companies, crew and officers. 1.4 It is expected that, as companies and shipowners increasingly explore electronic record-keeping, flag Stat